

March 15, 2025

Trustible Comments on the Request for Information (RFI) on the Development of an Artificial Intelligence (AI) Action Plan

To the Office of Science and Technology Policy:

On behalf of Trustible, a leading technology company based in Virginia that helps build trust through AI governance software, we appreciate the opportunity to submit comments in response to the Office of Science and Technology Policy's RFI on developing an AI Action Plan.¹

Trustible provides a Software as a Service platform that leverages AI to help large and medium size organizations implement internal processes to manage and oversee their use of AI. Trustible supports the Administration's goal to sustain and enhance America's global AI competitiveness and innovation. In order for the U.S. to maintain and build upon its AI leadership, we should encourage an AI ecosystem that leverages our world-class technology infrastructure and build trust amongst innovative AI tools. Innovation and trust flourish when there are common sense, industry-driven standards available for technology companies to adopt at scale.

I. The Second Trump Administration Can Continue Its Work from the First Trump Administration by Promoting Common Sense, Pragmatic Standards.

We encourage the Trump Administration to convene pragmatic stakeholders from across industry, academia, and other faucets of civil society to create technical standards that build trust in AI technologies. Establishing a practical set of AI standards helps grow the AI ecosystem and economy because companies that adopt those standards can demonstrate a basic level of reliability for their AI tools – enhancing the marketability and procurement of these systems. As part of our work, we gain valuable insights from the private sector about its development and adoption of AI tools. We consistently hear from companies that they want certain assurances about AI technology before they adopt it.

President Trump understood the importance that standards have in building trust and growing economic opportunity when he signed the Executive Order on Maintaining American Leadership in AI in February 2019. We encourage the Administration to build upon the success it achieved with regards to issuing technical standards. The current standards landscape is more saturated with guidance for foundational model creators than companies that integrate or deploy these models for their own products and services. However, foundation model creators are vastly outnumbered by organizations that are not developing their own models. While these organizations may have strong subject matter expertise, they may lack the requisite talent to demonstrate trustworthiness in their systems that is found in frontier model labs.

¹ Our comments are approved for public dissemination and contain no business-proprietary or confidential information. We understand that the contents of these comments may be reused by the government in developing the AI Action Plan and associated documents without attribution.

Therefore, standards can be extremely valuable for non-frontier model companies because it provides them with a baseline of scalable best practices.

II. The Trump Administration Can Learn from the Cybersecurity Ecosystem to Develop Scalable AI Standards.

The Administration should reference the success with cybersecurity standards as a roadmap for continuing its work on developing AI standards. Standards, such as the Service Organization Control 2 (SOC-2), Payment Card Industry Data Security Standard, and HITRUST, set attainable goals for companies to achieve while also helping them set a strong foundation for cybersecurity practices. These standards are particularly helpful for small and medium enterprises (SMEs) because they are market driven efforts that lower entry barriers for companies who may otherwise not have been able to demonstrate a baseline level of cybersecurity practices for their customers. In fact, SOC-2's scalability helped us build trust with potential and existing customers. An auditable standard tailored towards AI can make recommendations for companies, particularly SMEs, that deploy AI systems but not develop them. We should avoid the pitfalls of critics who assert that standards simply serve as "check the box exercise," when in practice these standards assist smaller enterprises like ourselves with understanding the types of cybersecurity controls to implement. Instead, the Administration should view AI standards as a means to help entrepreneurs and new SMEs incorporate best practices from rational industry AI experts.

III. The Trump Administration Should Lead on AI Standards to Promote American Values in the AI Ecosystem.

In the absence of continued U.S. leadership on AI standards, there is a heightened risk for other countries and international bodies to dictate heavy-handed protocols that are the antithesis of U.S. freedom, competitiveness, and innovation. There are many emerging standards that either impose unattainable requirements for SMEs or prevent operationalization due to overbroad and convoluted language. As a fast-growing startup company, we understand the unique challenges that entrepreneurs and SMEs face when trying to demonstrate trust in their products to prospective customers. The Administration can help avoid these barriers by encouraging the development of guidance or standards that are scalable for early AI startups or tools to increase the market adoption of these technologies.

Trustible appreciates and supports the Trump Administration's efforts to meaningfully engage stakeholders on how best to position the U.S. as a global leader in AI. Being the leader in AI standards will help achieve that goal, while also unlocking America's technological innovation and economic prosperity. Trustible looks forward to building a meaningful partnership with the Administration as it continues to pursue a robust AI policy agenda.

Respectfully,

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